

[NT Lesson 20](#): “Woe unto You, ... Hypocrites” John 12:1-8 and Matt. 21-23 (See NTL20 [Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us recognize and avoid hypocrisy and thus strengthen our commitment to Jesus Christ.

†1. Introduction and Timeline for John 11-13;

Remember when Jesus raised Lazarus from the dead. (See John 11: 1-46.)

• Read [John 11:46-48, 53-54](#). The Pharisees and Sadducees conspire to murder our Savior.

1. Mary anoints Jesus’ feet.

• Read [John 12:1-8](#). Judas said “Why was not this ointment sold for three hundred pence, and given to the poor?”

†2. Spikenard’s Value †3. Elder James E. Talmage

How do we show our love for the Lord?

• John 12:4-6. Judas criticized Mary “not that he cared for the poor; but because he was a thief, and had the bag”.

How was Judas a hypocrite? †4. Elder James E. Talmage †5. Hypocrite

2. Jesus makes a triumphal entry into Jerusalem.

• Read [Matthew 21:1-11](#). “Go ye into the village ... and ... ye shall find an ass tied, and a colt with her”.

†6. The Crowds at Jesus’s Triumphal Entry †7. Symbolism of the Donkey

Others rejected Him. In what ways do people misunderstand or reject the Savior today?

How can we more fully accept and welcome him into our lives?

3. Jesus gives the parable of the two sons and the parable of the householder.

• Read [Matthew 21:23-46](#). “A certain man had two sons ... to the first ... Son, go work to day in my vineyard.”

• Matthew 21:28-30. “He answered and said, I will not: but afterward he repented, and went.”

How were the publicans and harlots like the first son and the chief priests and elders like the second son?

How was the second son a hypocrite? How are we sometimes like the second son?

How can we help each other keep the promises we have made to the Lord?

• Matthew 21:33-41. “There was a certain householder, which planted a vineyard ... and let it out to husbandmen”.

How were the Jewish religious leaders like the husbandmen?

• Matthew 21:42-44. “The stone which the builders rejected ...”

What will happen to builders who reject Christ, the chief cornerstone? How do Jesus’s words apply to us?

• Matthew 21:45-46. The “chief priests and Pharisees ... perceived that he spake of them” and were angry.

How can we overcome any pride or indignation we may feel when we are called to repent?

4. The scribes and Pharisees try to trap Jesus.

• Read [Matthew 22:15-46](#). The Pharisees “took counsel how they might entangle him in his talk.”

• Matthew 22:15-21. **First trap:** “Is it lawful to give tribute unto Caesar, or not?” Note: “if Jesus said yes ... they could accuse him of supporting the hated Roman government. If he said no, they could accuse him of rebellion against the government.” (*Lesson Manual*)

• Matthew 22:23-30. **Second trap:** The Sadducees “pretended to be concerned about marriage in the resurrection, but they did not believe in the resurrection... Doctrine and Covenants 132:15-16, 19 clarifies Jesus’ teaching.” (*Lesson Manual*)

• Matthew 22:34-40. **Third trap:** “Master, which is the great commandment in the law?”

Why do you think these two great commandments are so important?

What can we do to more fully live these commandments?

5. Jesus condemns the sin of hypocrisy.

• [Matthew 23](#). “Then spake Jesus to the multitude, and to his disciples.”

“The scribes and Pharisees paid tithing, gave to the poor, attended worship services and went regularly to the temple.”

What caused the Lord to condemn them?

• [Matthew 23:5, 14, 23-28](#). “Ye ... outwardly appear righteous unto men, but within ye are full of ... iniquity.”

How might we as Church members sometimes be hypocrites? †8. Becoming Hypocrites

What can we do to avoid or reduce hypocrisy and remove it from our lives? †9. Elder Marlin K. Jensen

Next Week: L21 “What is the Sign of Thy Coming”; See L21: [Class Member Study Guide](#).

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212](#).) † •

NTL20 Quotes

†1. **Introduction and Timeline for John 11-13:** “John devoted almost half of his Gospel to the last week of Jesus Christ’s mortal life. Just prior to his final week, the Savior raised Lazarus from the dead—a miracle that emphasized the power and love of the Son of God (see John 11:1-46). Because of the miraculous raising of Lazarus, plans to murder Jesus intensified. Jesus retreated for a time to a place called Ephraim, but then went back to Bethany, where Mary honored Him with an act of sincere devotion by anointing his feet with ointment (see John 12:1-3), and others—including Judas Iscariot—plotted to destroy him. Jesus Christ manifested His perfect love for His disciples at the Last Supper by washing their feet. He then taught them that love should characterize their lives as his disciples (see John 13:1-17, 34-35). Despite the turbulence of the final week of his mortal ministry, Jesus Christ focused his teachings on obedience, service, and love—attributes that defined His life and should define the lives of His disciples in all ages.” (“[Introduction and Timeline for John 11-13](#),” *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, 2014)

†2. **Spikenard’s value:** Note: One pence [or one Roman denarii] equaled a laborer’s wages for twelve hours, roughly one day. So at a minimum wage of \$7.50 per hour multiplied by 12 hours in a workday equaled \$90 or a day’s wage. To multiply that by 300 days gives us a value of \$27,000 for Mary’s pound of spikenard, or as the scriptures said, “very costly”.

†3. **Elder James E. Talmage:** “To anoint the head of a guest with ordinary oil was to do him honor; to anoint his feet also was to show unusual and signal regard; but the anointing of head and feet with spikenard, and in such abundance, was an act of reverential homage rarely rendered even to kings. Mary’s act was an expression of adoration; it was the fragrant outwelling of a heart overflowing with worship and affection” (*Jesus the Christ*, 3rd ed. [1916], 512).

†4. **Elder James E. Talmage:** “Judas Iscariot treasurer of the Twelve, but dishonest, avaricious, and small-souled in character, vented his grumbling complaint ... His seeming solicitude for the poor was all hypocrisy. He was a thief and lamented that he had not been given the precious ointment to sell, or that the price had not been turned into the bag of which he was the self-interested custodian. (*Jesus the Christ*, 38th ed. [1970], 512-513)

†5. **Hypocrite:** [Vocabulary.com](#): “A hypocrite preaches one thing, and does another... “The word *hypocrite* is rooted in the Greek word *hypokrites*, which means “stage actor, pretender, [dissembler](#).”

†6. **Crowds at Jesus’s Triumphal Entry:** “When “Jesus returned to Jerusalem for the Passover, many people came to see him because they heard that he had raised Lazarus from the dead ([John 12:17-18](#)). As Jesus approached the city, he was greeted by a great multitude of people who spread their garments in his path and hailed him with palm branches, an honor usually reserved for kings and conquerors. This fulfilled a prophecy by Zechariah ([Zechariah 9:9](#)) and was a further witness that Jesus was the promised Messiah.” (*Lesson Manual*)

†7. **Symbolism of the Donkey:** “The symbolism of the donkey may also refer to the Eastern tradition that it is an animal of peace, versus the horse, which is the animal of war.^[1] Therefore, a king came riding upon a horse when he was bent on war and rode upon a donkey when he wanted to point out that he was coming in peace. Therefore Jesus’ entry to Jerusalem symbolized his entry as the Prince of Peace, not as a war waging king.^[2] ([Wikipedia: Triumphal entry into Jerusalem](#))

†8. **Becoming Hypocrites:** “(For example, when we attend Church meetings we may be more concerned with being seen by others than by worshiping God. We may complain about Church assignments where we do not receive much attention for our service. We may sustain our Church leaders and criticize their decisions.)” (*Lesson Manual*)

†9. **Elder Marlin K. Jensen:** “Another wonderful benefit of living according to standards we have internalized is that we gradually eliminate hypocrisy from our thinking and our behavior. The English word hypocrisy comes from a Greek word which means playing a part upon a stage. Until standards become part of our basic character, we sometimes play the role of a religious person without really being one. As we search for our true identity, we may behave like chameleons, frequently changing colors to blend with our surroundings. We act one way at school, another at church.” (“[Making a Mighty Change](#), *New Era*, June 2001)

Recommended Reading:

1. *New Testament Student Manual: Religion 211-212*, “[Introduction and Timelines for John 11-13](#), 2014.
2. [NT20 Enrichment.pdf](#) contains more fine quotes and links to articles and speeches.

Recommended Videos:

1. [Lesson 20: New Testament Customs—Phylacteries](#) (1:11)

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